



ALEONPRESS

BONUS GUIDE 4 OF 4

The Job Search Playbook

A practical system for running your search like a project — where to look, how to stay organized, and how to keep momentum.

01

Set Your Target Before You Start

A job search without a target turns into applying to everything and hearing back from nothing. Before your first application, write down:

- 2–3 job titles you're realistically qualified for right now
- Your must-haves (salary floor, location/remote, schedule) vs. nice-to-haves
- A short list of 10–15 companies you'd genuinely want to work for

TIP

A focused search of 5–10 well-tailored applications a week beats 50 generic ones. Quality of application matters more than volume.

02

Where to Actually Look

- **Company career pages** — apply directly when possible; some companies deprioritize job-board applicants
- **Job boards** — Indeed, LinkedIn Jobs, and industry-specific boards for your field
- **Your network** — tell people you're looking; a referral dramatically increases your odds of a first interview
- **Recruiters** — worth connecting with 2–3 in your field even if you're not actively searching yet

THE 40/40/20 RULE

Roughly: 40% of your search time on tailored applications, 40% on networking and outreach, 20% on interview prep and skill-building. Most people spend 90% of their time on applications alone and wonder why nothing lands.

03

Staying Organized

Use the included Job Application Tracker to log every application: company, role, date applied, status, and next action. A messy search — forgetting who you applied to, missing a follow-up — costs you interviews you'd have otherwise gotten.

- Update the tracker the moment you apply, not "later"
- Set a follow-up reminder for 7–10 days after each application with no response
- Review the tracker weekly to see what's stalling and where to focus next

04

Networking Outreach Templates

COLD OUTREACH TO SOMEONE AT A TARGET COMPANY

EXAMPLE

Hi [Name], I came across your profile while researching [Company] — I'm currently exploring [role type] opportunities and was really drawn to [specific thing about the company/team]. Would you be open to a quick 15-minute chat about your experience there? Happy to work around your schedule.

ASKING A FORMER COLLEAGUE FOR A REFERRAL

EXAMPLE

Hi [Name], hope you're doing well! I saw [Company] has an opening for [Role] and I'd love to apply — would you be comfortable referring me, or connecting me with the hiring manager? Happy to send my resume over.

05

Staying Motivated Through Rejection

Rejection — or silence — is the default outcome of most applications, even for strong candidates. That's a function of volume, not a verdict on your worth.

- Set a weekly application target you can hit consistently, not a daily one that burns you out
- Batch your hardest tasks (cold outreach, tailoring) into one or two focused sessions a week
- Celebrate process wins — an application sent, a conversation booked — not just offers
- Take a full day off from the search each week; a rested search outperforms a constant one

06

A Simple 30-Day Plan

WEEK 1

Finalize your resume, cover letter, and target list. Update LinkedIn. Begin applying to your top 5 companies.

WEEK 2

Continue applying (5–10/week). Start networking outreach — aim for 3 conversations.

WEEK 3

Follow up on Week 1 applications. Keep applying and networking. Begin interview prep for any responses.

WEEK 4

Review your tracker: what's working, what isn't. Adjust your target list or resume if response rates are low. Keep the pipeline moving.